

THE WINNING BALANCE

Building Customer Trust at Scale

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CHAPTER 1

CHANGES

A New World

A 29-day voyage from the Canary Islands in 1492 changed the fate of the entire world. Not many of the sunbathers who visit really think about the historic relevance of the place. Why would they? While they enjoy the sun and fine food, the Gulf Stream quietly passes on its way to the Caribbean, from where it goes north and then back east, bringing a mild climate to central Europe. It's that southern loop of the Gulf Stream that takes sailing boats across the Atlantic. In a little natural harbor in La Gomera, the westernmost island of the Canary Islands, Christopher Columbus made a last stop before he set out to discover a western passage to India⁴. What is a sun destination today, was then the launch platform for discovering a new world.

While Columbus is known for discovering America, he already had a decade-long journey behind him to secure the support and funds he needed. It was ultimately Isabella I of Castile and King Ferdinand II of Aragon who stepped up.⁵ They weren't fully convinced of the success of his idea to find the western sea passage to India but believed it would be better to take the risk than to miss the opportunity. Thirty six days after the Niña, the Pinta, and the Santa Maria had set sail, they saw land, and what followed was nothing less than the historical milestone of the second millennium AD. Europe became the Old World, and America became the New World.

Columbus was successful because he did not give up lobbying for his idea. Repeatedly and tirelessly, he rallied believers and pitched sponsors for support. Then, once he had funding, he saw his plan through to the end. And that makes this a great example of a groundbreaking change. Achieving the seemingly impossible requires a story, a need for change,

believers, sponsors, a plan, brave explorers, and the willingness to take risks and persistence until you've reached your goal.

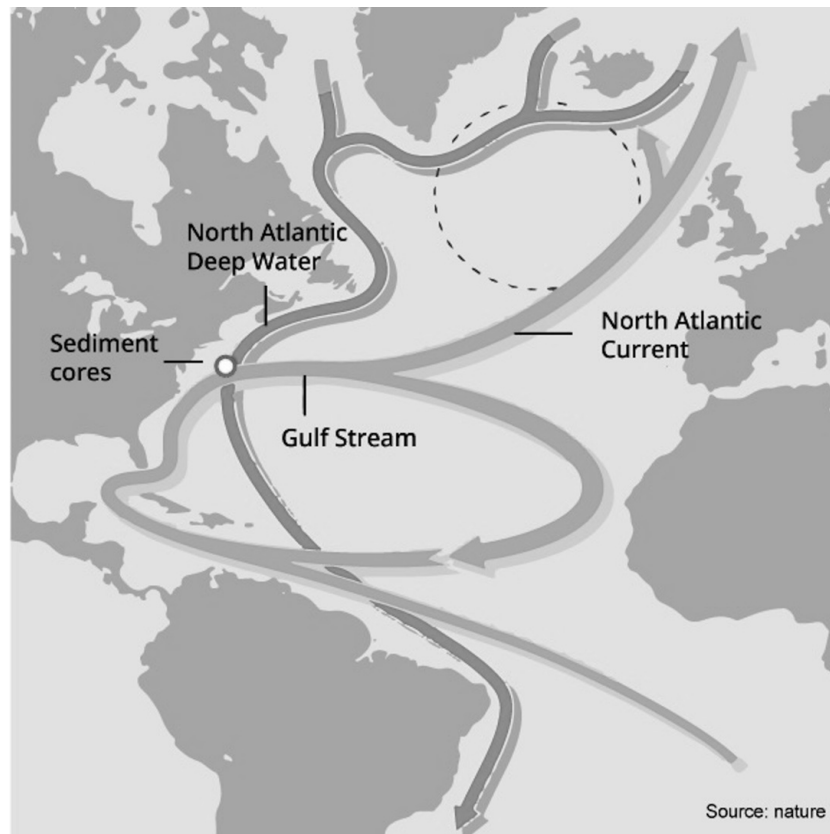


Figure 2 The Gulf Stream⁶

That same blueprint applies today. Like Columbus convincing monarchs to fund a voyage into the unknown, leaders today must rally belief, secure backing, chart a course, and persist through resistance. Some organizations have made the leap. They've left behind the safety of the old world and are thriving in a new identity, more connected, more responsive, more human. Others remain adrift, clinging to outdated maps, hoping the old winds will still carry them forward. But they won't.

Crossing into a new operating model isn't something you can flip on like a light switch. It demands more than a strategic plan. It takes belief, design, courage, and commitment. And perhaps most importantly, it requires rewriting the rules we were raised with, the deeply embedded

assumptions we've carried since the first day we stepped into a classroom or a company. These rules shape how we think about control, leadership, efficiency, and value. They're so familiar, we rarely question them.

But before we can chart a new course, we need to understand the waters we're sailing through. The logic we've inherited, born in the Industrial Age and reinforced over decades, still quietly governs how we work. Until we make that logic visible, we'll keep repeating the same patterns, no matter how bold our intentions. That's why we invite you to take a step back; not to admire the past, but to understand the forces that continue to shape the present.

From the Industrial Revolution to the Modern Era

Until the mid-1850s, manufacturing was done in people's homes, using hand tools or basic machines. Goods were sold locally, often in exchange for other goods. It was the modern age that shifted manufacturing to factories and mass production using powered, special-purpose machinery. The Industrial Revolution offered jobs for millions of people and brought to the masses products that would otherwise be affordable only to the wealthy class.

The ability to manufacture products in high volume quickly became the major goal. The Ford Motor Company developed the moving assembly line system to bring its Model T automobile to the public at affordable prices. Frederick W. Taylor's scientific management methods, known as Taylorism, further revolutionized manufacturing by focusing on the efficiency and speed of the worker.⁷ Together, efficiencies in both the manufacturing process and the workers exponentially increased production capacities to previously unknown heights. At the time, whoever was able to mass-produce a product at an attractive price point had a competitive edge in the market.

Many of the systems and standards developed in this Age of Manufacturing are still actively used today. More than a hundred years ago, our current

social systems were created. Labor laws were established and the social contract between workers and employers gained shape. We saw the introduction of health insurance and unions, as well as the division of tasks into functions like finance, sales, and logistics.⁸

Ironically, today's customer trends are swinging back toward pre-industrial values. Many of us prefer to use the local butcher or to get our vegetables from the farmer's markets. We buy artisan bread from a family-owned bakery and order handcrafted items on Etsy. We have grown tired of mass products and prefer to work much closer to where we live, ideally from home. That 'back to personal' approach won't be able to feed a world of a billion people, but they point to something deeper: a growing fatigue with scale for scale's sake.

By the early 1950s, after another world war and the extreme demand for war materials it had generated, most manufacturers knew how to set up efficient production. World War II also introduced the power of global logistics, and in turn, global trade emerged. In the 1950s, the volume of global trade started to grow exponentially and would continue to do so for the next sixty years.⁹ It was no accident that 1956 saw the introduction of the intermodal container. Malcom McLean and Keith Tantlinger developed a standard design for a cargo container that could be easily loaded and shipped on specially designed container ships on long sea voyages and then transported to their destination by either train or truck.¹⁰ Cities in strategically good locations around the world, like Vancouver, Singapore, and Hong Kong, owe their wealth to the value of goods flowing through their harbors. At about the same time, the era of mass air travel began. Airlines, especially American airlines like Pan Am, TWA and Continental, were bringing a new level of speed, comfort, and efficiency to the traveling public. Flying became commonplace in business, and when jet aircrafts began to replace piston-engine airliners, nonstop connections made flying more affordable and convenient. The world was getting smaller.

People changed from their older, austere habits of saving and reusing. Instead, they started spending more, buying all the fancy new goods the modern world had to offer. Manufacturers started to provide more

options that would accommodate every budget and desire. Each iteration provided opportunities to make the product more appealing, which in turn provided selling arguments to the consumer. It was chic to drive the car with the latest features or to have a next-generation television set with a remote control. In a sense, customers became prey to companies and their power of persuasion. Billboard, radio, and TV campaigns turned customers into consumers.

By itself, mass production was no longer enough. To win, companies had to make the product appealing, sell it hard, and get it to market fast. The postwar boom brought prosperity unlike anything seen before. It also locked in a new pattern: companies would bet on product innovation to keep the wheel spinning.

Growth of global exports

Total world exports adjusted for inflation (constant prices), relative to 1913. Values correspond to world export volumes indexed to 1913.

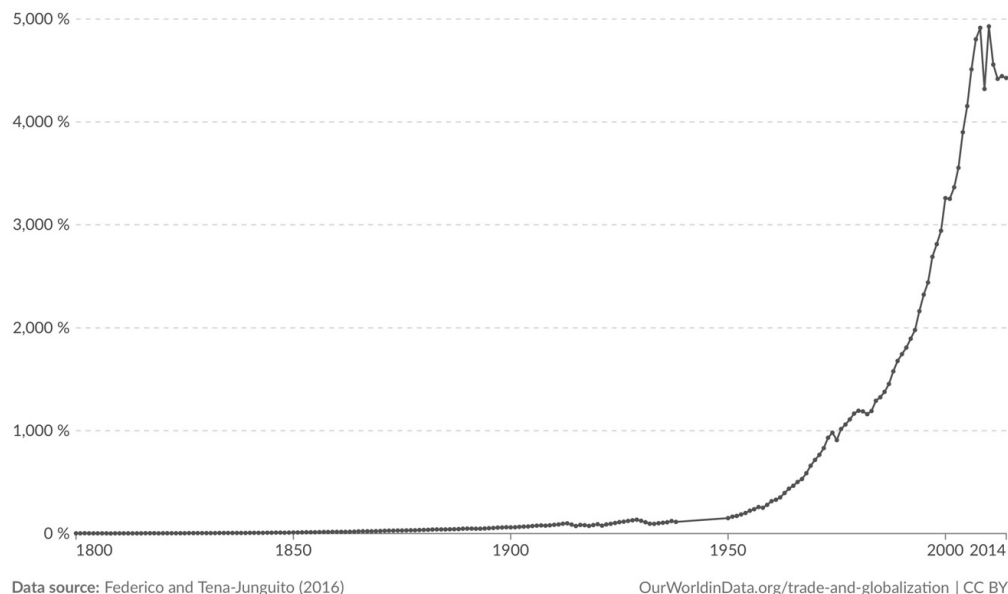


Figure 3 Growth of Global Exports Following WWII¹¹

Enter the 1980s.

With their oversized blazers, shoulder pads, and clouds of permed hair, the 1980s marked the peak of an industrial era mindset. It was a decade of global competition, linear hierarchies, and manufactured ambition.

Nowhere was this more visible than in Japan. Japanese companies had mastered the game: world-class manufacturing, relentless product innovation, and global reach. They produced the Walkman (Sony), the first mass-produced laptop (Toshiba), the VHS recorder (JVC), and sleek LCD screens (Sharp). Japan has led the way in tech and consumer electronics.¹²¹³



Figure 4 1980s Japanese Tech¹⁴

Their influence extended to automobiles as well. By the early 1980s, Japanese automakers controlled more than 70 percent of U.S. auto imports and captured close to a quarter of the overall American car market. President Ronald Reagan imposed import tariffs in response, but it backfired. Japanese manufacturers leaned into the challenge, promoting better mileage and winning even more customers.^{15 16} In a bold move, Sony acquired Columbia Pictures in 1989, hoping to marry hardware and content¹⁷. Japan's economy was booming. Some even predicted it would overtake the West.

But it didn't. The next paradigm shift wasn't geographic. It was systemic.

For all their excellence in production, Japanese companies, like their Western counterparts, were still playing the same game: make more, make it better, sell it everywhere. But the next winners weren't going to out-produce the old ones. They were going to change what it meant

to compete through a shift already forming on the horizon. Silently but steadily. For the first time in 150 years, progress was becoming less visible. From hardware to software. From machines to information. The world was about to be turned upside down.

At first glance, not much seemed different, but it was during the 1990s that the world ultimately started to morph from a world of things to a world of information. The shift wasn't apparent at first. Personal computers were still big (and ugly), the internet was more novelty than necessity, and hardware continued to improve at a breathtaking pace. DVDs, hybrid cars like the Toyota Prius, unmanned drones, portable MP3 players, and cell phones were among the many innovations of that decade. We were obsessed with every new processor generation, from 386 and 486 to the mighty Intel Pentium. Moore's Law could be experienced firsthand: every time we bought a new computer, it was dramatically faster than the two-year-old model it replaced. Because the hardware made such dramatic strides, we didn't notice at the time that the software and information on those machines had become a more valuable asset than the machines themselves. The value was moving off the factory floor into the ether.

In the enterprise world, the age of information brought dramatic changes. For decades, governments and large corporations had relied on mainframes. However, in the 1990s, client-server architecture made systems like SAP and Oracle accessible to midsize firms. For the first time, companies could run payroll, manage inventory, and track customers in real time with insight, control, and speed unthinkable just a decade earlier. McDonald's, for instance, was already monitoring daily sales from every store. A sudden drop in one location could trigger a call from HQ, even if the only culprit was road construction.¹⁸ Imagine what they can do with AI-driven tools in the year 2025. The Information Age had arrived, but we didn't yet realize just how deeply it would change the rules.

Sidebar: Remember ‘before the internet’? In the 1980s, stores had printed lists of stolen credit cards. If someone didn’t show up at a meeting in 1991, you just waited. To find a street in 1998, you used a printed map, flipped to the back for coordinates, and then plotted the route by hand. The global median age in 2021 was 30.¹⁹ That means half the world’s population has never known life before the web. The other half remembers. Organizations today must bridge both mindsets for at least another generation.

In the early 1990s, the new internet helped companies manage their business more efficiently but also had a profound impact on consumer behavior. For decades, companies had the advantage of knowing more than their largely uninformed customers. There might have been word-of-mouth information about the qualities or deficiencies of a product, or people might have read a review in a printed magazine or newspaper. But, for the most part, making smart purchasing decisions required good old-fashioned legwork. Within only a few years, however, the internet gave us well-informed, price-aware buyers on all levels.¹²⁰

Figure 1 We Have Entered The Age Of The Customer

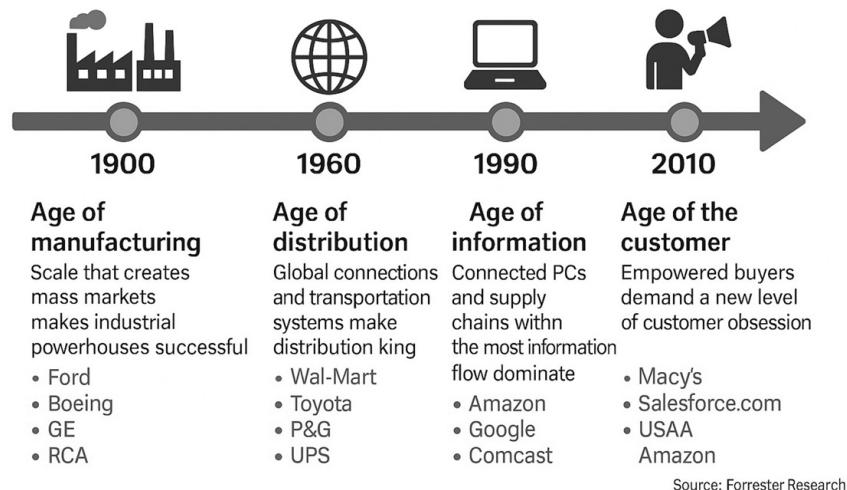


Figure 5 We Have Entered the Age of the Customer²¹

¹ In 1995, the Pew Research Center did just that, finding 14 percent of U.S. adults with internet access. That number grew to 46 percent in 2000 and 87 percent in 2014.

Consumer behavior shifted dramatically. As the World Wide Web developed and millions of people had access to information, consumers began to move their checking accounts to banks with better offerings, change their energy provider to save costs, shop online at websites with the lowest prices, and hold off signing a purchase agreement for a new car unless the discount matched the terms and figures they found online in a car buyers' forum. Loyal customers who once sourced all their needs locally evolved into fully informed opponents who knew all the specifications for a desired product, assessed its quality and usefulness in online reviews, and were able to source it from numerous locations. The passive buyer became the active evaluator. Enter Amazon.

The Company That Changed Us

Amazon is both a child and a driver of the Age of Information. As a tech-powered online retailer, Amazon is an expert with data. It was born into a world that was already connected over the internet. As a result, it had no baggage like other companies that had been around for decades. Moreover, from the very beginning, Amazon has put the customer at the center of everything it does. It had all the necessary knowledge and philosophy of running a mass consumer business at its fingertips and took it to a previously unknown level. In an incredible short fifteen years, it developed from an online bookstore into the go-to place for most of our consumer needs.²²

How long have you been shopping at Amazon? Perhaps you joined eBay in the early 2000s and then opened your Amazon account soon after. If you don't remember when you stepped into founder Jeff Bezos' infinite world of online shopping, Amazon tells you on your account page. In my case, it says, "Customer since 2003". Amazing! I wouldn't be able to look up when I first became a customer at say Walmart, Target, or Dick's Sporting Goods. Do you want to know how much you spent on Amazon in total over all those years, or how often you shop at Amazon? The 'Your Account' tab will tell you. In my case, we as a family had 121 orders in the year 2023 on Amazon.com. That's one order about every three days and an amount of spending I'd rather not disclose!

As a customer-focused data powerhouse, Amazon has shaped our lives in more ways than we know.

Convenience. We've come to enjoy the fact that so many different products can be found in one place. The added convenience of one password and already-saved credit information is unbeatable.

Speed. A 2020 RBC Markets report estimated that Amazon's operational advantage saved the company billions, not just in logistics, but in faster feedback loops, innovation cycles, and customer acquisition.²³

Reliability. Amazon's on-time delivery rate is typically in the high 90s.²⁴ In an average week, 9.8 out of ten parcels arrive at their destination on the promised date. Again, world-class.

Transparency. We have gotten used to Amazon's post-order communication. We are informed when the order is received, when it is shipped, and when it's delivered. If we like, we can also check its progress using the tracking number. All these steps give consumers unprecedented transparency and control.

Price. Studies indicate that 82 percent of all customers say they shop on Amazon because of the price.²⁵ Is Amazon always the cheapest? Probably not. Yet, as consumers, we have confidence in Amazon's value guarantee. There is a good chance we won't find our product cheaper somewhere else, at least not with a company as convenient, fast, reliable, and transparent as Amazon.

Speedy delivery. The faster the item arrives, the more Amazon saves customers from a shopping trip to a brick-and-mortar store. They've tried same-day delivery for a selection of products, however, customers never appreciated it when a delivery came at 11 o'clock at night. While technically being delivered on the same day, it doesn't fulfill the high expectations that come with a 'same day' promise. So Amazon now offers overnight shipping with a time window of 'next day, 4 a.m. to 11 a.m.' instead. And that might already have changed by the time you read these words.

Driven by their customer obsession, Amazon constantly innovates and improves. How does the customer prefer to have their package delivered? Directly into the house would be great! OK, how could we do this fast and efficiently? For those with a connected garage door, we could ask them to provide us with the door code, and we'll put the package inside. Sounds weird at first, but this is not science fiction. It's a real service Amazon offers, and once you have gotten used to finding your deliveries in your own garage, it is not creepy at all.

Starting with the solution in mind, like same-day delivery, was a new way of thinking in a world of companies that added product features every year to keep customers interested. This approach, later receiving the fancy title 'Design Thinking,' was a revolution. For over a century, companies raced to make, improve, and deliver their product. They believed that if the product was good and available, there would always be customers. The new kids on the block, like Amazon, started with what customers wanted and needed and then figured out how to pull it off. Again, revolutionary.

As consumers, our world can be divided into a time without and a time with Amazon. We have become impatient, spoiled by their reliability, transparency, speed, and convenience. If the customer service department of some other company does not answer your email within hours? Then that's bad customer service. It takes two days for another online retailer to ship a product. Why does it take them so long? Can't they do it like Amazon? The product you've ordered arrives two weeks later than promised? Unacceptable! And the ease of doing business? Why do I have to go through a customer service representative to order a part instead of going through an easy online ordering process with full transparency and, almost, best price guarantee? Consumers don't necessarily ask themselves these more technical questions, but they feel the different vibe when they interact with Amazon and the new economy.

It's a good exercise to ask oneself how one's own business measures up against Amazon:

- ☑ Do we make it convenient to deal with us?
- ☑ Do we especially shine when solving complex customer issues with grace and friendliness?
- ☑ Is our non-customer-facing organization as fired up about the customer as the salespeople?
- ☑ Do we always start with the customer in mind, or are we driven by our capabilities to develop, make or ship a product instead?
- ☑ Do we deliver products and solutions faster and more reliably than everyone else?
- ☑ Do our customers have full insight into when they receive their product?
- ☑ Do our customers have peace of mind that they got the best deal from us?

Amazon has shaped consumers' expectations in almost every facet and has set service level standards for literally every segment. And since everyone is an Amazon customer, all your suppliers, partners and customers have their 'Amazon glasses' on: you are judged by Amazon standards. Nothing less. We all live in the Amazon world.

Product Orientation Has Run Its Course

Amazon is the poster child among the organizations we call customer-centric companies or COCs. While they and others were redefining service level standards and reinventing the way business can be done, existing companies were slow to change their decades-old proven success formula, driving profit through new or newer products.

Those product-oriented companies, or POCs, were suffocated by the very mechanism that made them successful in the first place. Let's use a beloved

icon like BMW to explain what this means. BMW started manufacturing cars a few decades later than Mercedes. They introduced their first real mainstream car only in the early 1970s.²⁶ However, they were determined to surpass Mercedes and become the number one premium car brand in the world. An entire generation of managers, engineers, and marketing geniuses was focused on developing, building, and selling the best cars in the world. And they succeeded. When BMW introduced a new model, it was an important event. With every new generation of the 3, 5, or 7 Series, technological advancements could be easily experienced: less noise, better build quality, better material, more speed, better mileage, air conditioning, powered helpers everywhere, and more. Customers took pilgrimages to the world's largest auto show in Frankfurt whenever BMW presented a new model.²⁷

Those times are gone now. We don't even recognize anymore when a new version of BMW's successful 3 Series is introduced. This is not because the cars look like their predecessors or are no longer any good. (Far from it, the opposite is true: a recent 3 Series BMW is probably one of the best cars you could ever buy for money.) However, the consumer focus shifted. Features such as two percent better handling at 250 km/h or incredible stability in ultrafast driven turns were celebrated as major advancements in the 20th century but no longer appeal to a broader audience and are moot as selling arguments. The only people excited about such 'advancements' are motor journalists, car aficionados, and of course the companies that are stuck in their product-oriented mindset. As if it were a rule of nature, they add a feature like 'better handling in fast driven turns', well, because they can. Not because a consumer asked for it. Despite what the marketing departments tell you, be assured that even the cars from twenty years ago were good enough for everyone's needs today. Getting people reliably, comfortably, and safely in a human-driven car from A to B is a solved problem.

The story could have been different in the last twenty years. Imagine established players in the automotive industry would have just updated the design to accommodate changing consumer tastes but would have invested every remaining budget into connectivity and autonomous driving. Those brands would be lightyears ahead of the competition today, but that's not how POCs are set up. They rely on their current capabilities, like improving

a car's suspension or improving fuel efficiency while overlooking emerging customer priorities. Instead, they are still hoping that the next new product iteration will get them back onto the path of success. But there is a good chance it won't and that this strategy is simply outdated. What they don't want to realize is that the consumer has checked out already. Brand loyalty is more fragile than ever. Someone who drives an Audi today could purchase a Mercedes tomorrow, maybe even Kia next week. And that won't change with a minuscule upgrade of the product's capabilities.

It would be bad enough if it were just lower customer loyalty, but there is more trouble POCs need to deal with: they are all prone to disruption. In the car world, we saw Tesla's rise ten years ago, but other industries have been disrupted much earlier. In the early 2000s, the Irish airline Ryanair created a space of its own with radically simplified booking and reduced amenities.²⁸ Passengers would have to print their tickets at home. They would pay extra for checked bags and onboard service. They would be lined up at the gate and pushed like a herd of cattle for efficient boarding. They would have to drive to much smaller provincial airports because these charged Ryanair significantly lower fees. They would have to make all those sacrifices to fly for just \$30 between European cities. And they did. Ryanair created an alternative approach to passenger transport driven by tech and the internet. At the time, every established airline had gone into providing more service and premium features like better meals and more comfortable seats at higher prices. As POCs, they didn't realize they were limiting themselves to customers with bigger budgets, leaving a gap in the market for cheap, simple, reliable air transportation.

Ryanair benefited from that blindness and achieved tremendous success. Passengers did not mind being treated like cattle if it saved them a significant amount of money and found their way to the provincial airports. Travelers whose ticket read "Frankfurt" expected to depart from the international hub, when it was actually in reference to a small runway some 90 minutes outside of the city, a runway Ryanair had renamed 'Frankfurt (Hahn)'. When they finally arrived in what they thought was Venice, they realized that Ryanair's 'Venice' was also an hour from the city and had no train or bus service into the city. The expensive taxi services cost a fortune, but passengers didn't mind. All the hustle seemed to be okay after they had paid only \$30 for the actual plane ticket. Ryanair was the first, and

for a while, they enjoyed the open playing field without any competitors. Ryanair had discovered Mauborgne's & Kim's blue ocean, where "demand is created rather than fought over and with ample opportunity for profitable and rapid growth."²⁹

Sidebar: What Ryanair is to Lufthansa is what Tesla is to BMW. They have a different view of the product. Ryanair could also be operating hotels or grocery stores, it's all about the philosophy of taking a mainstream product and using modern technology to make it simple and cheap. Teslas are basically driving smartphones. They are good cars, but not in the sense of a 20th century car. This less traditional perspective on their own product frees both companies of much of the 20th century management approach. It lets them act on customers' needs rather than being focused on the next product iteration.

However, just like Tesla's, Ryanair's advantage did not last long. Within just a few years, EasyJet, Norwegian Air, Vueling, and German Wings entered the promising niche and turned it into a crowded market, a 'red ocean'.³⁰ Ryanair had galvanized millions of people who previously never considered boarding an airplane straight from the tarmac in the middle of nowhere, but now they saw their growth decline and their product turn into a commodity. And that is the third force that POCs must reckon with: ubiquitous competition.

Blue oceans are market spaces free from competition and are created constantly; consider online auctions with eBay, Netflix shifting from DVD rental to streaming service, and the simple, affordable, and enjoyable gaming with the Nintendo Wii console. However, like Ryanair, none of those companies could enjoy their unique position for very long. Catching up with the competition is a ubiquitous skill that was developed in the 20th century. It's great to have a product that stands out, but the time to exploit a niche is very limited. That makes a strategy built on relentless product innovation a game of luck.

Ultimately, every product is already or will become a commodity. Just a trip to the shampoo aisle of the local grocery or drug store reveals the unprecedented times we are living in. In the US alone, there are over thirty-five shampoo brands on the market with each millions of users. And there are countless boutique offerings on top of that. Now that's not necessarily new. Douglas Coupland has already made shampoo the main obsession of his character Tyler in his 1992 novel 'Shampoo Planet'.³¹ It's been confusing to buy shampoo for a long time if you just want something to wash your hair. The same goes for cars, airline travel or really anything now.

We can see that same mechanism—ubiquitous competition, turning every product into a commodity—in every segment. If you were to buy a premium car in the 1980s, you would tend to buy a BMW, Mercedes or Cadillac. If you are in the market for a premium brand today, there are a few more options to choose from. It depends on where you draw the line between 'premium' and 'not premium,' but you can easily find twenty brands that fit that category. Premium midsize SUV? BMW X5, Mercedes GLE, Volvo XC90, Audi Q5/Q7, Porsche Cayenne, Cadillac Escalade, Lincoln Navigator and more from Infiniti, Lexus, Maserati, Land Rover, Genesis and so on. Premium cars have become attainable and ubiquitous. A once stand-out market position turned into a crowded red ocean.

It's everywhere. Try to pick a microwave, a tire, an Android smartphone, a kitchen cooktop, a home entertainment system, or even the brand of paint color for your living room. There is hardly any product left that enjoys exclusivity. As consumers, we've gotten used to choosing from at least three to five alternatives.

Also, it's a sign of the times that products in the same category have strikingly similar quality. You must be a fan to prefer a Mercedes over a BMW. Your choice of microwave comes down to your familiarity with the brand, its more appealing visual appearance or its price. Performance-wise, there is not much, if any, difference between one or the other product. Manufacturers will tell you otherwise, but essentially all their competing products in the same price range are of the same quality, the same features and have usually only minor differences.

How come everything is so similar? Well, again, 20th century companies have mastered the basics. They have the development and manufacturing know-how, and they have established practices for pushing a product to the consumer. As a result, no single company has a significant advantage over the others in the field. Employees all come from the same business schools (see sidebar) and have worked across the industry, taking their knowledge from one competitor to the next. We're all reading the same (business) books, listening to the same influencers and occasionally hiring the same consultants to help us make changes. That levels the playing field, and there is no way to escape that.

Sidebar: The POC's recipe of success during the twentieth century is well known and taught in business schools around the world. What do schools teach?

Here is an extract of the curriculum for undergraduate students in the business school at Villanova University: business intelligence, business performance management, and business analytics tools, such as statistical analysis and data mining. Understanding of the economy, fiscal performance, and financial products. Skills in analytical thinking, quantitative analysis, ethics, and technology. Analyze consumer behavior and market trends, develop and implement value-driven products and services, and strategically manage product pricing, promotion and distribution. And more. These are the business basics, which apparently still apply, but it reads like a 20th century business bootcamp.³²

In consequence, those who build the hope that their unique team (note: it is not unique) will come up with a product that blows the competition out of the water are futile. Even if they gain a slight advantage, it will be only momentarily. A technological surprise like the iPhone was replicated within less than two years, and today's innovation cycles are even faster. Whatever you do, your competitors will offer essentially the same thing within the next twelve months at the same price, quality and with similar

features. There is not enough time to reap the benefits of investment until it is exposed to the rough winds of ubiquitous competition.

The game has changed irreversibly. In a marketplace where nearly every product can be matched in quality, features, and price within months, the battleground has shifted away from the product itself. Commoditization, amplified by the infinite shelf space of the internet and the radical transparency it enables, has created a new kind of customer. They move with ease between brands, guided not by loyalty to what you make, but by the value and experience you deliver in the moment.

To understand how to win in this reality, we must first understand that the new customer holds all the cards now. To see what this change feels like in real life, let's start with the story of one family, one booking, and one summer night in a stifling hotel room.